GEORGE G. MEADE
TOP 3 LEGENDARY TACTICAL MOVES

Publishing guide: everything you need to upload the finished video



Main thumbnail: STAY AND FIGHT (battlefield made with vidIQ; Meade's public-domain Brady portrait added on top)

1. The finished video

Item	Details
File	Meade-Top3-1080p.mp4 (1920x1080, 30 fps, H.264 + AAC, 689 MB)
Download	(Gofile link: see chat)
Length	16:18
Voice	Voice A: Kokoro am_michael converted to the owner's voice (reference: the approved voice-A sample)
Music	Kevin MacLeod, 4 tracks, CC BY 4.0, ducked under the voice (locked level 0.08)
Sound effects	The channel's locked kit: Freesound recordings (CC BY / CC0), Mixkit sounds, original effects
Flags	Owner's pick A1 (also for Gettysburg): US 34-star flag + Confederate First National ('Stars and Bars'); never the battle flag

Chapters

Starts	Chapter
0:00	Intro: The Man Who Beat Lee at Gettysburg
1:14	Who Was George Meade?
2:10	Move 1: The Breakthrough at Fredericksburg (Dec 1862)
3:24	The Gap in Jackson's Line
4:28	No Support
5:58	Six Months Later
6:17	Move 2: Holding the Line at Gettysburg (2 Jul 1863)
7:16	Interior Lines
7:44	Sickles Moves Forward
8:50	The Race Along the Inside of the Hook
10:26	Move 3: Stopping Pickett's Charge (3 Jul 1863)
11:54	The Great Bombardment
12:47	Pickett's Charge
14:22	The Fourth of July
14:46	Lee Escapes
15:22	Legacy

Key frames: the hook (0:00-1:14)


Meade #12 - HOOK (hook-a getty_hd_ref hook-1..3 + hook-b penn_hd_ref hook-4), 0:00-1:14
Locked hook: card at 0.3 s, dive 5.3 s, a beat every 2-4 s (frames every ~2.5 s to 0:28), REPULSED ~0:23, white flash, twist stamps, name slam + 3 snap cuts + title. Union blue / Confederate red; US 34-star + First National.
0:00.5
0
KILLED · WOUNDED · CAPTURED · MISSING
Frame 0: Gettysburg wide, option 1 (night 1-2 Jul), red columns on the road spokes (A.P. HILL, EWELL), blue corps from
gun launches + impacts (shake), hit + shake, ticks
0:02.5
47,000
KILLED · WOUNDED · CAPTURED · MISSING
ticks, pops, impact + shake
0:05.0
51,000
KILLED · WOUNDED · CAPTURED · MISSING
IN 3 DAYS
IN 3 DAYS stamp; cards lift off
hit + shake
0:06.3
Zoom-whoosh DIVE onto the fishhook: blue line glows on Cemetery Ridge, red wraps the outside; close counters
whoosh (zoom #1), pops
0:08.0
72,000
ROBERT E. LEE
72,000 ROBERT E. LEE card slams; ridge labels
hit + shake
0:09.9
94,000
ITS GENERAL: ?
72,000
ROBERT E. LEE
94,000 ITS GENERAL: ? card; IN COMMAND: 3 DAYS stamp
hit + shake x2
0:12.6
0:15.0
12,500
0:17.4
12,500

2. Title and thumbnail

Title (locked, vidIQ score 88)

George Meade's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves | The Man Who Beat Lee at Gettysburg

Alternatives (vidIQ scores):

- George Meade's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves | The Man Who Stopped Pickett's Charge (87)
- George Meade's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves | The Man Who Saved the Union at Gettysburg (87)
- George Meade's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves | The Man Who Won Gettysburg (87)

Why this thumbnail

Tactical Genius picture formula: a dark aerial battlefield with red/blue unit blocks and white arrows on the left, the commander on the right, a red brush banner bottom-left. **STAY AND FIGHT** is type 1 (the hero's decision in plain words): the council of war on the night of 2 July, the video's 'What would you do?' moment, and the reason Lee's charge hit a line that was waiting for it.

Alternative for YouTube's Test & compare: **“MY FAULT”** (type 2: the enemy's own words; Lee to General Wilcox after Pickett's Charge, as Fremantle wrote it down: 'all this has been my fault').



Checked: the AI image drew small red flags in the Confederate lines; they were painted out (no battle flag anywhere). We added SEMINARY RIDGE, CEMETERY RIDGE, PICKETT and MEADE. Infantry, guns and smoke only (no tanks, aircraft or modern vehicles). The portrait is Meade's real Brady photograph (Library of Congress, public domain), not an AI likeness.

Before uploading: check the thumbnail at small size on a phone.

3. Description (copy and paste)

The first line is the title. Everything after it is the description: ready to paste, with NO links (channel rule). Keep the credit lines: the music, sound and image licences require them.

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George Meade's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves | The Man Who Beat Lee at Gettysburg

Fifty-one thousand men killed, wounded, captured or missing in three days, and the general who had
to stop Robert E. Lee had been in command for just three days. On the last day, twelve and a half
thousand of Lee's men marched across open fields straight at his centre. In less than an hour,
about half of them were killed, wounded or captured.

In this video we break down George Gordon Meade's three greatest tactical moves: the breakthrough
at Fredericksburg on 13 December 1862, where his Pennsylvania division found the one gap in
Stonewall Jackson's line; the second day at Gettysburg, 2 July 1863, when Meade held a breaking
line together by moving troops across the inside of his fishhook position; and the third day, 3
July 1863, when he told John Gibbon the night before exactly where Lee would strike, and Pickett's
Charge broke against the Union centre.

Find the gap. Hold the inside line. Read the next blow.

Which was his greatest move: 1, 2 or 3? Tell us in the comments, and tell us which commander we
should cover next.

CHAPTERS
0:00 Intro: The Man Who Beat Lee at Gettysburg
1:14 Who Was George Meade?
2:10 Move 1: The Breakthrough at Fredericksburg (Dec 1862)
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SOURCES
The War of the Rebellion: Official Records of the Union and Confederate Armies, Series I, vols. 21
and 27
The Life and Letters of George Gordon Meade (1913), incl. Meade's letters to his wife
Battles and Leaders of the Civil War, vol. III (Century, 1888): John Gibbon, "The Council of War on
the Second Day"; Henry J. Hunt, "The Third Day at Gettysburg"
Arthur J. L. Fremantle, Three Months in the Southern States (1863)
Frank A. Haskell, The Battle of Gettysburg
Abraham Lincoln's unsent letter to George G. Meade, 14 July 1863
National Park Service: Gettysburg National Military Park, Fredericksburg & Spotsylvania National
Military Park
American Battlefield Trust battle pages

CREDITS
Maps: original animations. Terrain: Mapzen / AWS Terrain Tiles (open data). Map data ©
OpenStreetMap contributors (ODbL).

Music by Kevin MacLeod (incompetech.com): "Long Note One", "Wounded", "Long Note Two", "Anguish".
Licensed under Creative Commons: By Attribution 4.0.

Sound effects: "artillery distance" by 2887679652 (CC BY 4.0), "Cannon Artillery distant gunshots"
by Aegersum (CC BY 3.0), "Distant explosion" by juskiddink (CC BY 4.0), "Distant explosions" by
Kostrava (CC0), via freesound.org. Transition sounds: Mixkit (Mixkit Sound Effects Free License).
Other sound effects: original.

Images: Library of Congress (no known restrictions; photographs by Mathew Brady's studio, Alexander
Gardner, Timothy O'Sullivan and others; sketches by Alfred Waud). Some portraits and flags:
Wikimedia Commons (public domain); portrait of J. Johnston Pettigrew after a painting by William
Garl Browne Jr. (public domain).

Narration voice: AI-generated. Maps: original animations.
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■ Business enquiries: [email to fill in]

#Gettysburg #CivilWar #MilitaryHistory

4. Upload settings

Setting	Value
Tags	military history, civil war documentary, George Meade, George Gordon Meade, Battle of Gettysburg, Pickett's Charge, Battle of Fredericksburg, Little Round Top, Robert E. Lee, Daniel Sickles, Winfield Scott Hancock, Henry Hunt, Stonewall Jackson, Army of the Potomac, animated battle map, greatest military tactics, american civil war animated history
Category	Education
Audience	Not made for kids
Language / captions	English; let YouTube auto-caption, then check the names (Meade, Fredericksburg, Rappahannock, Franklin, Birney, Gibbon, Maxcy Gregg, Gettysburg, Sickles, Gouverneur Warren, Culp's Hill, Hancock, Leister, Hunt, Pickett, Pettigrew, Trimble, Armistead, Emmitsburg Road, Fremantle, Vicksburg)
Altered or synthetic content	Yes: the narration is an AI voice and the thumbnail battlefield is AI-generated. Tick the disclosure box.
Chapters	Automatic from the description (first chapter is 0:00)
Pinned comment	Which was Meade's greatest move: 1, 2 or 3? And which commander should we cover next?
Schedule	Your audience's peak time (YouTube Studio > Analytics > Audience)

Upload checklist

- Play the 1080p master through once (sound, sync, no black frames).
- Upload the master.
- Paste title, description and tags; upload the thumbnail (1280x720).
- Fill in the business email in the description.
- Tick 'altered or synthetic content'.
- Add end screen and cards; set visibility and schedule.
- After 24-48 h: check click-through rate and 30-second retention; if CTR is under 2% after ~1,000 impressions, switch to the alternative thumbnail.

Facts to double-check before publishing (approximate, single-source or second-hand; see research/FACT_NOTES*.md):
• Meade's division losses at Fredericksburg: report 1,770 (40%); revised OR return ~1,853 (OCR, check page image); script says 'about eighteen hundred'.
• Confederate losses at Fredericksburg (Lee's return ~5,300 vs ABT ~6,000); army sizes ~120,000 / ~78,000 (ABT 123,000 / 78,000).
• Birney episode ('almost made the stones creep'): Sears via a secondary site; 'Walker's guns' label; pontoon dates 11-12 Dec.
• Pickett's Charge losses: ABT 6,555 vs NPS ~5,500; Union ~1,500 (ABT) / ~1,700 (NPS). Battle totals are ABT's (Confederate 28,063; other counts ~23,000).
• Meade at the head of Lockwood's brigade and Baldy hit on 2 July: the family narrative in Life and Letters (said 'by his family's account').
• Gibbon's 'in your front' quote: his own recollection (1887); Lydia Leister's seventeen horses: her 1865 account.
• Sickles's move 'around 2 pm'; Vincent 'minutes ahead'; Hancock ordering the 1st Minnesota; Sickles lost a leg; rain on the night of 4 July; brigade names on the 2 July attack arrows.
• Thanks of Congress 28 Jan 1864; Meade's death 6 Nov 1872 (Philadelphia); Great Lakes survey; 'Old

Snapping Turtle' (NPS, no 1863 source).
• All front lines, control areas and some positions are approximate (research/FACT_NOTES_*.md).